SES requires verification before sending emails. Start with enabling sandbox mode by adding your email address to the allowlist as follows:

1. Open SES in the AWS Management Console.
2. Select Verified Identities from the menu.
3. Click Create Identity.
4. Choose the identity type Email Address.
5. Type in your email address.
6. Click Create Identity.
7. Check your inbox, and click the verification link.

Please note: you need to request production access to ensure SES is delivering emails to any address. To follow our example, however, this isn't needed.

The next listing defines the virtual machine and the startup script to install and configure Discourse.

Listing 11.6 CloudFormation template for Discourse: Virtual machine

```
Resources:
  # [...]
  InstanceSecurityGroup:
    Type: 'AWS::EC2::SecurityGroup'
    Properties:
      GroupDescription: 'vm'
      SecurityGroupIngress:
      - CidrIp: '0.0.0.0/0'                                          ①
        FromPort: 80
        IpProtocol: tcp
        ToPort: 80
      VpcId: !Ref VPC
  Instance:                                                          ②
    Type: 'AWS::EC2::Instance'
    Properties:
      ImageId: !FindInMap [RegionMap, !Ref 'AWS::Region', AMI]
      InstanceType: 't2.micro'
      IamInstanceProfile: !Ref InstanceProfile
      NetworkInterfaces:
      - AssociatePublicIpAddress: true
        DeleteOnTermination: true
        DeviceIndex: 0
        GroupSet:
        - !Ref InstanceSecurityGroup
        SubnetId: !Ref SubnetA
      BlockDeviceMappings:
      - DeviceName: '/dev/xvda'
        Ebs:
          VolumeSize: 16                                             ③
          VolumeType: gp2
      UserData:
        'Fn::Base64': !Sub |
          #!/bin/bash -x
```